

First aid





Wounds

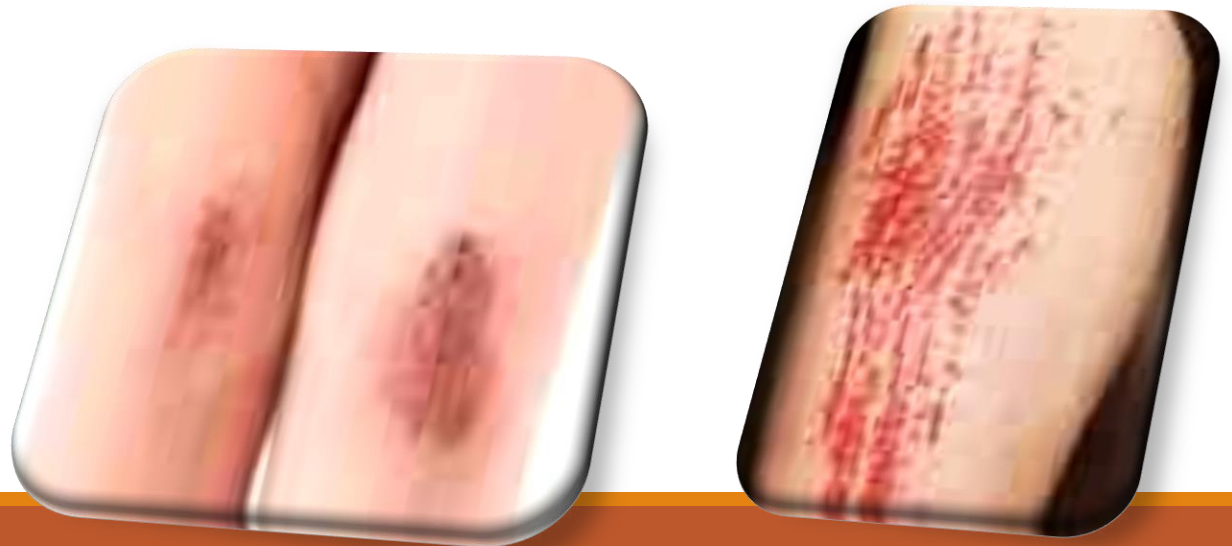
Definition:

It is a break in the continuity of the skin's surface, it may be associated with internal /or external bleeding.



1 – An abrasion:

The top layer of skin is removed, with little or no blood loss. It can be serious if it covers a large area or if foreign matter becomes embedded in it.



2- Incision:

It has regular edge resembling a surgical cut and caused by sharp instrument such as knife or arbor.



3- Laceration:

It is cut skin with irregular edges. It is usually caused by machine, wire barded and glass.



4- Contusion:

It is characterized by injury of the soft parts, hemorrhage and swelling, it is caused by blunt instrument or it may be due to blow.



5- Punctures

They are usually deep, narrow wounds in the skin and underlying organs. It is caused by nail or needle.



6- Gunshot wound:

It is characterized by small entry, larger exit, this wound is associated with extensive injuries.



7- Avulsion:

It is when a flap of skin is torn and become loose and is either hanging from the body or completely removed.



8- Amputation:

It involves the cutting or tearing off a body part such as a finger, toe, hand, foot, arm or leg.



Complication and Dangers of wounds

1. Injury to blood vessels, nerves and tendons.
2. Wound infection.
3. Hemorrhage.
4. Shock.

First aid of wounds



Reassure the victim.



Protect yourself by wearing latex gloves. If they are not available, use plastic wrap or bags or water proof material.

Lay the victim **down** in a suitable and comfortable position slightly lower the head if possible.

Expose the wound by removing or cutting the clothing to see where the blood is coming from.

If the wound is unclean, **wash it** with running water if possible.

Control bleeding by putting a sterile or clean cloth over the wound.

Apply direct pressure with fingers or the hand palms.

Keep the dressing in position with firm bandage.

Elevate the injured area above heart level to reduce blood flow.

After stoppage of bleeding apply pressure bandage to hold dressing on wound.

Immobilize the injured part by a suitable method.

- For an upper limb: a sling.
- For a lower limb: tying it to the other limb.

Transfer carefully to hospital as soon as possible, if needed





Bleeding

Bleeding :

It is escape of blood from the blood vessels. Bleeding may occur externally or internally.

Types of bleeding:

External bleeding

Internal bleeding

External bleeding

An open wound is known when blood can be seen coming from an injury.

Hemorrhage :Refers to a large amount of bleeding in a short time.

External bleeding

- 1- Capillary bleeding: it characterized by a slow general ooze of blood.
- 2- Venous bleeding: blood flows steadily and it is dark in color.
- 3- Arterial bleeding: blood gushes of spurts with each heartbeat and is bright in color.

Signs and symptoms of hemorrhage

1- Pale face and lips

2- Cold clammy (moist) skin

3- Dizzy and faint

4- Rapid and weak Pulse" thread"

5- Subnormal temperature

6- Restlessness, apprehension

7- Respiration are rapid and shallow. and air hunger

First aid for bleeding



Applying pressure on either side of the object

Raising the area above the victim heart level.

Drape a piece of gauze over the wound and object.

Use 3 Ps technique to stop bleeding

Direct pressure on wound

Elevated part above heart level

Pressure point :on the nearest blood supply to wound

Internal bleeding

It occurs when the skin is **unbroken** & blood is **not visible**.

It may be more **serious** than external bleeding.

It comes from injuries that **do not** break the skin or from non traumatic disorders such as ulcers.

It can occur in the **abdominal cavity** as a result of perforation of organ or as a result of accident.

Signs of internal bleeding

- 1- Bruises or contusion on skin
- 2- Painful , tender rigid bruised abdomen
- 3- Fractured ribs or bruises on chest
- 4- Vomiting or coughing up blood

Signs of internal bleeding

1-Contusion

2-Hematemesis: vomiting of blood.

3-Rectal bleeding or Melena: tary stool (black due to blood) or fresh blood as cancer colon, rectum, hemorrhoids & anal fissure and liver disease.

5-Epistaxis: bleeding from nose.

5-Hemoptysis: coughing of blood, as in pulmonary infection (T.B), lung abscess, neoplasms, vascular lesions as pulmonary infarction.

6-Vaginal bleeding: passage of blood from vagina as in case of cancer cervix.

First aid for bleeding

- 1- Lay the **victim down** with his head low and to one side to ensure a good blood supply to brain & prevent aspiration if vomiting occurs. Ask not to move.
- 2- If injuries allow, **raise** leg to aid the return of blood flow to the vital organs.
- 3- **Loosen** any constricting clothing around neck, chest and waist.
- 4- **Reassure** and explain the necessity to relax..

- 5- Check **breathing** and **pulse** rate and level of responsiveness at 10-minute intervals, and record these for the doctor.
- 6- **Examine** the victim for other injuries and treat as necessary.
- 7- If **unconscious**, keep airway open and check breathing and complete the ABC of resuscitation .
- 8- Keep the victim **covered** and place a blanket underneath him/her if possible.
- 9- Keep a **record** of any specimen passed or vomited by the victim.
- 10- **Arrange** urgent removal to hospital.

First aid for epistaxis

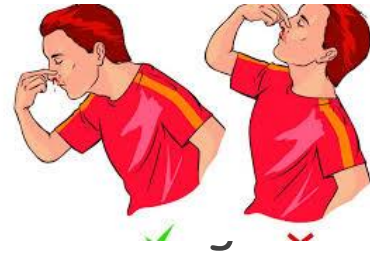
1. Ask the victim to **Sit** down.

2. Allow to Lean slightly forward to prevent blood from throat.

3. Instruct the victim to breathe through **mouth** and avoid **blowing** coughing and sniffing.

4. Place **cold, wet cloths** or an ice pack over the nose area to constrict the blood vessels in nose and stop the bleeding.

5. **Pinch** nostrils together for at least 10 minutes.



6. If bleeding continues, apply **pressure** for another 10 minutes.

7. If the bleeding is the result of direct injury to the nose, only **gentle pressure** should be applied.

8. Insert a piece of gauze saturated with local **vasoconstricting drug** (Adrenaline) into nostril.

9. If bleeding does not stop within short time, victim should be **transferred** to the hospital.

First aid for ear bleeding



1-Place the victim in **dorsal position**, head raised and inclined to side of injury.

2-Place **a dressing** or pad over the ear and secure it in position (avoid packing of the ear canal).

3-Observe **respiration** and **pulse**.

4-**Transfer** victim immediately to the hospital.

First aid for scalp bleeding



- 1- Apply **clean dressing** around the wound but not on the fracture or foreign body.
- 2- Observe **pulse** and **respiration** and level of responsiveness at **10 minutes** intervals.
- 3- If **unconscious** open airway and complete the ABC of resuscitation if required and place him/her in recovery position.
- 4- **Transfer** victim immediately to hospital.

Foreign Bodies (eye, ear and nose)

1- Foreign bodies in the eye:

Symptoms and signs:

- 1- Victim's eye is painful and itching.
 - 2- Victim's vision may be impaired.
 - 3- Eye is red.
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First aid:

- 1- Lift the upper lid over the lower lid, allowing the lashes to brush the object off the inside of the upper lid
- 2- Try flushing the object out by rinsing the eye gently with warm water.
- 3- Examine the lower lid by pulling it down gently. If you can see the object, flush with lukewarm water or wet sterile gauze.

4- if the foreign body is under the upper eyelid:

- Tell the victim to look down, pull upper eyelashes and lay a swab or matchstick across the top of the lid.
- Fold the lid over the swap or matchstick.
- Remove the object by gently flushing with lukewarm water or wet sterile gauze.
- If the above measure fails or if the particle is imbedded instill a little ophthalmic boric ointment or ophthalmic sterile vaseline into the eye, cover the eye with sterile dressing and get the victim to a doctor.

2- Foreign bodies in the ear:

Children often introduce solid objects as beans, peas, buttons or small seeds into ears. It can absorb moisture and makes the removal difficult.

First aid.

If the object is small and near ear canal opening, it can be removed by irrigating the ear with warm water.



3-Foreign bodies in the nose



If an insect or a foreign body like a grain is likely to swell has lodged in the nose,

First aid :

Few drops of olive oil or mineral oil may be dropped in, to relieve the irritation and help prevent swelling there is usually no immediate danger from these.

Go to a doctor as soon as possible the nose should not blow violently, and never be blow with one nostril held.

Good Luck